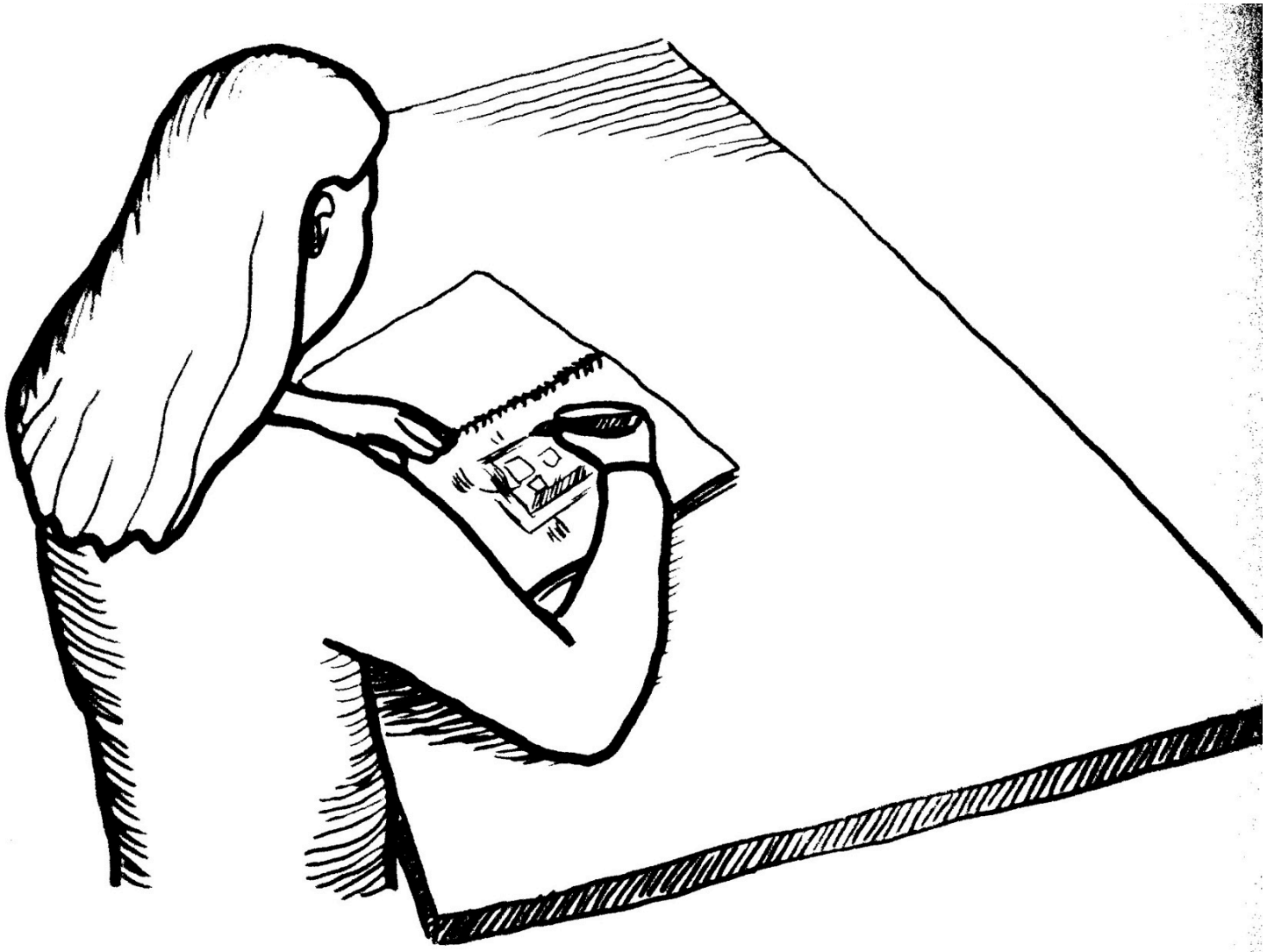
PAT 451 / 551 INTERACTIVE MEDIA DESIGN I

0.2 SKETCHING / INTERACTION DESIGN / AESTHETICS



A Sketch of Someone Sketching a Sketch

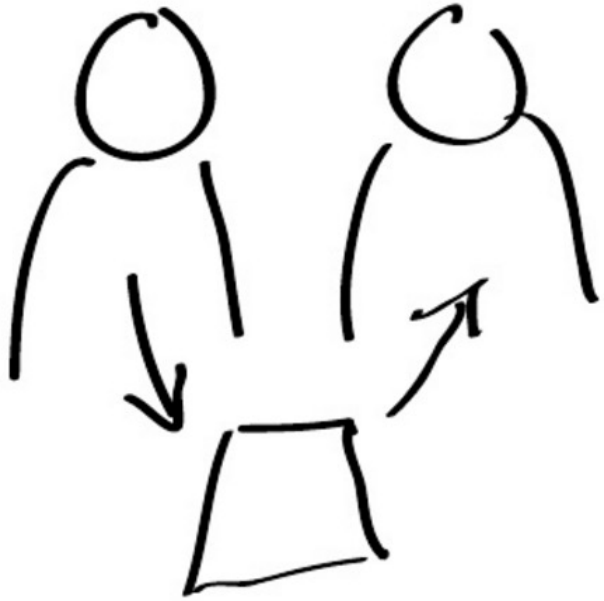
WHY SKETCH?



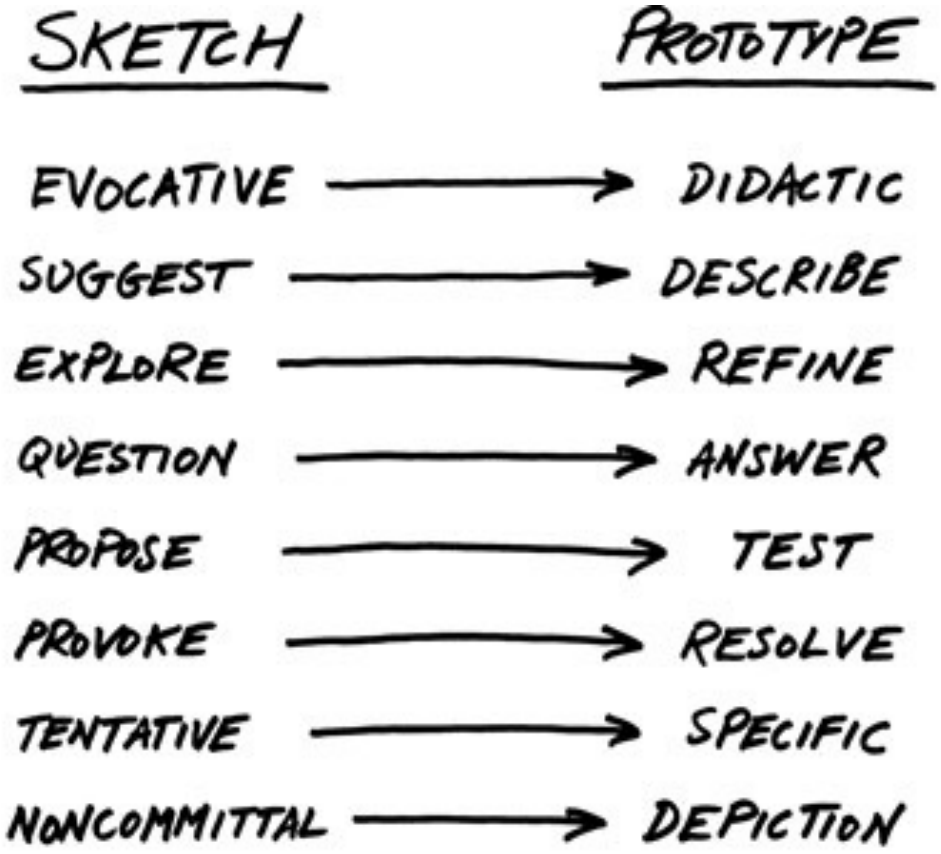
documentation



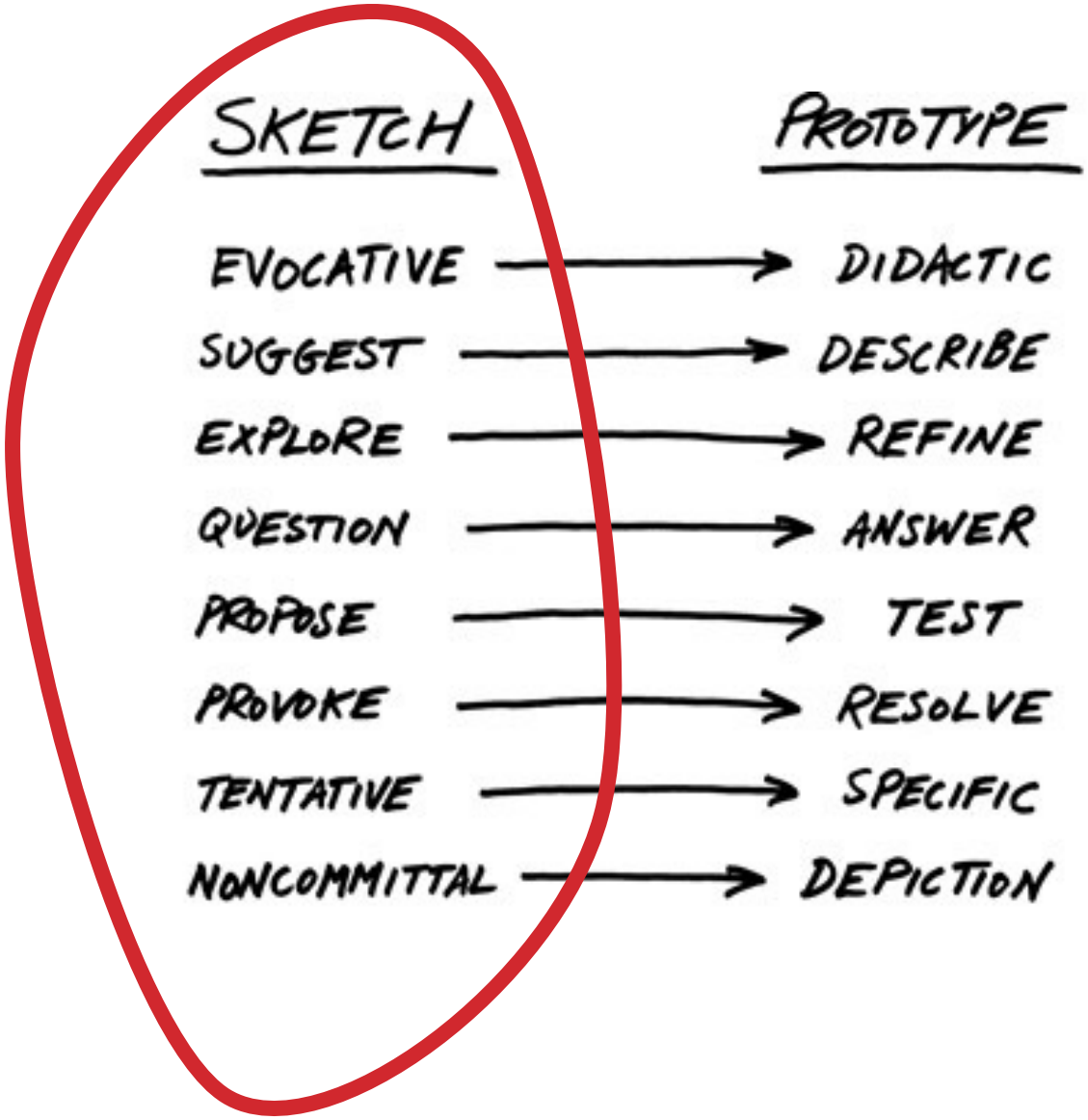
reflection



communication



Buxton, “The Sketch to Prototype Continuum.”
“The difference between the two is as much a contrast of purpose, or intent, as it is of form.”


SKETCH
PROTOTYPE
EVOCATIVE
DIDACTIC
SUGGEST
DESCRIBE
EXPLORE
REFINE
QUESTION
ANSWER
PROPOSE
TEST
PROVOKE
RESOLVE
TENTATIVE
SPECIFIC
NONCOMMITTAL
DEPICTION

Attributes of a Sketch (Buxton)

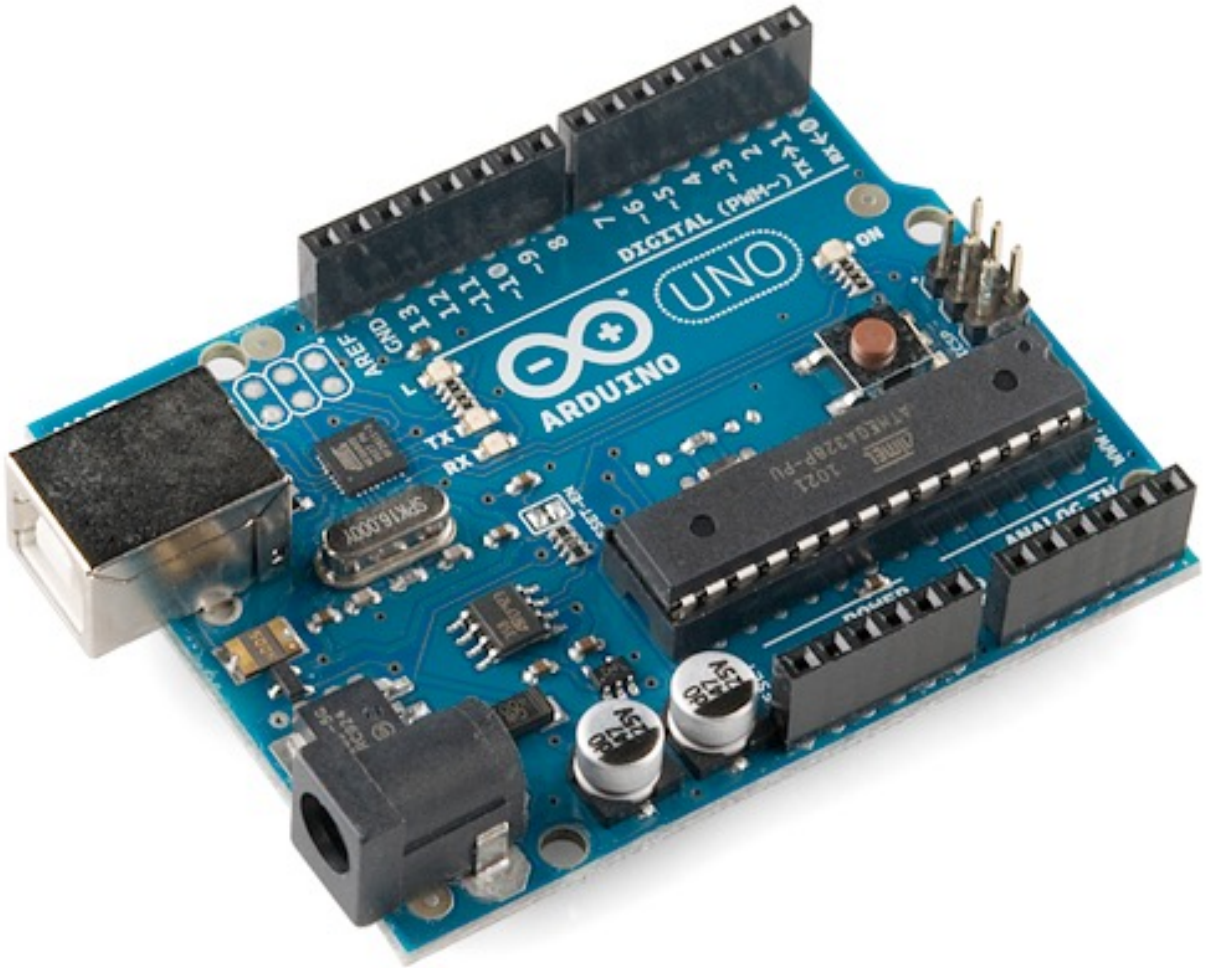
1. Quick
2. Timely
3. Inexpensive
4. Disposable
5. Plentiful
6. Clear vocabulary
7. Distinct gesture
8. Minimal Detail
9. Appropriate Degree of Refinement
10. Suggest and explore, rather than confirm
11. Ambiguity

DIFFERENT ATTRIBUTES -> DIFFERENT MODALITIES



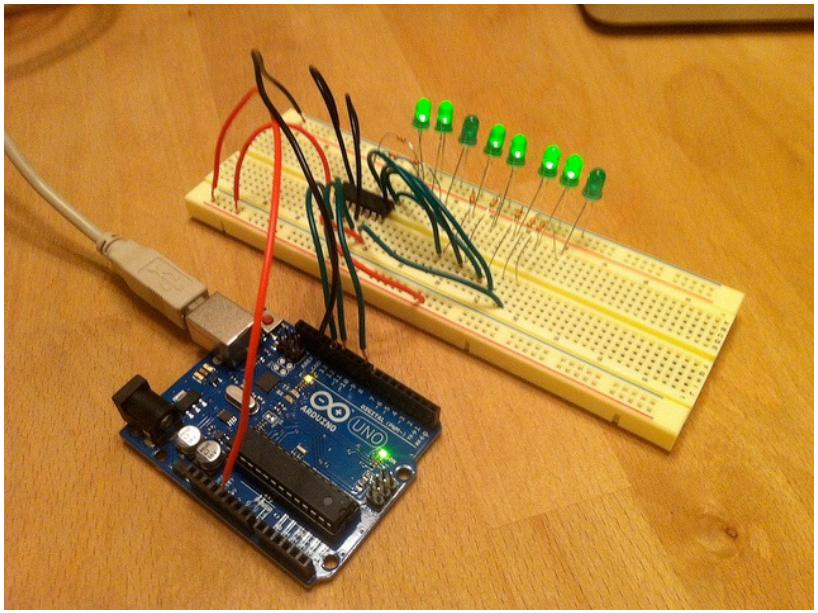
From Buxton

SKETCHING WITH INTERACTIVE ELECTRONICS



USING WHAT IS AT HAND



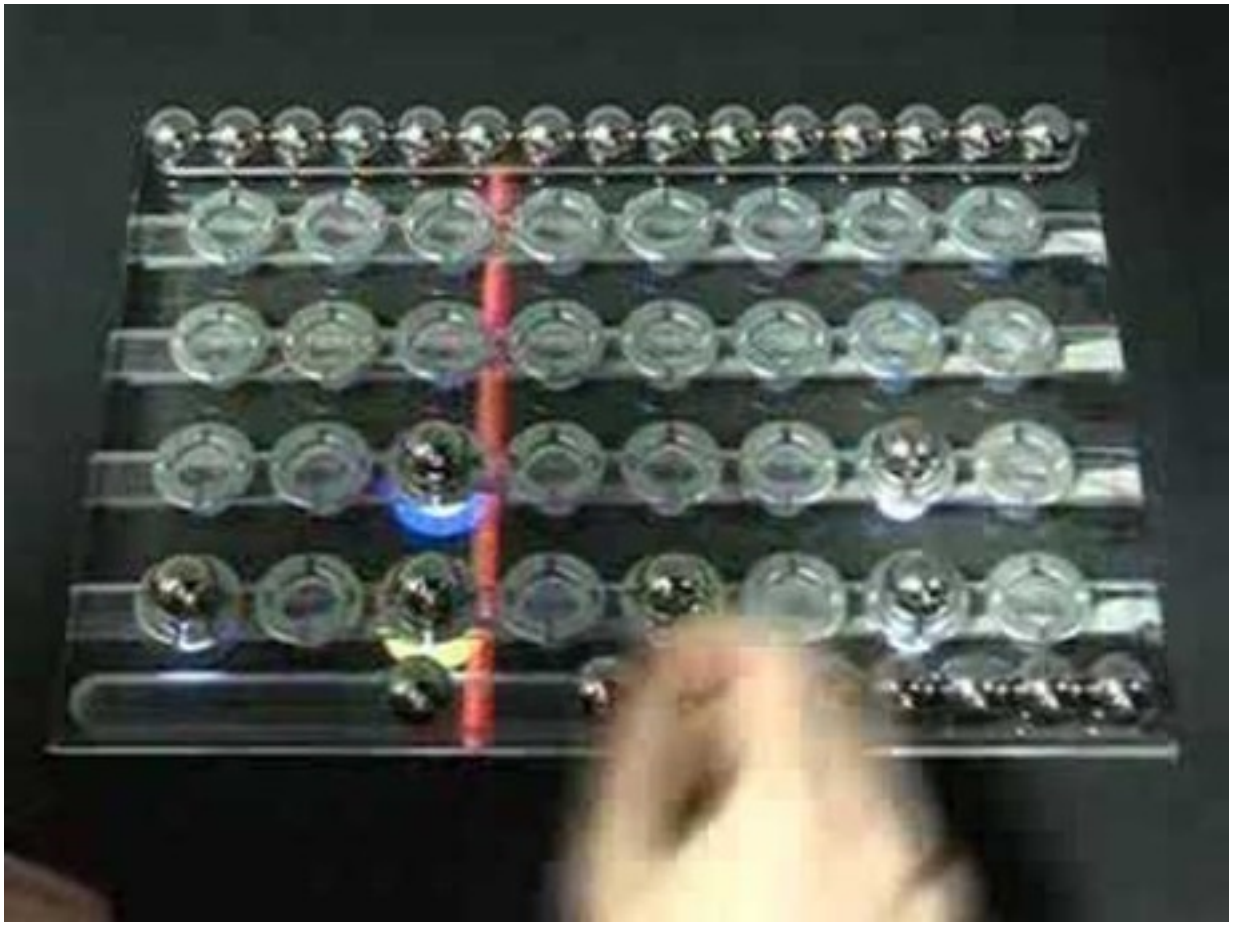


BEATBEARING SKETCHES – PETER BENNETT



http://youtu.be/5PZ5T-OHm_Y

BEATBEARING SKETCHES – PETER BENNETT

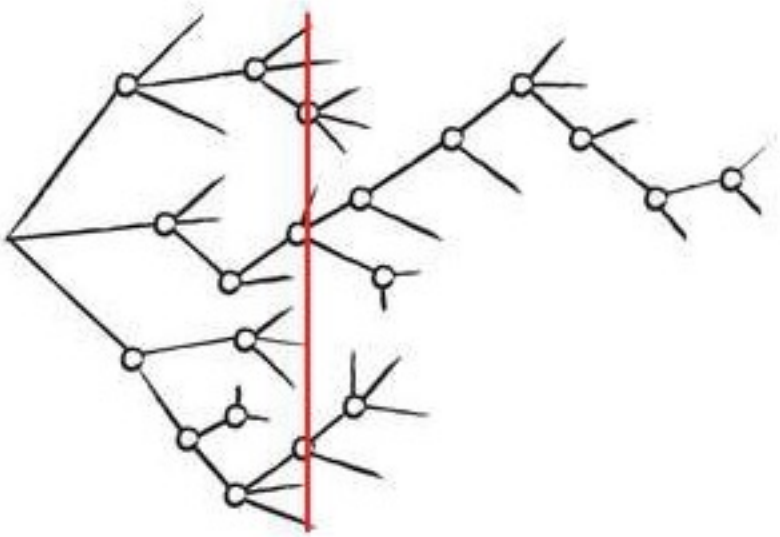


http://youtu.be/wreP8FMupyM

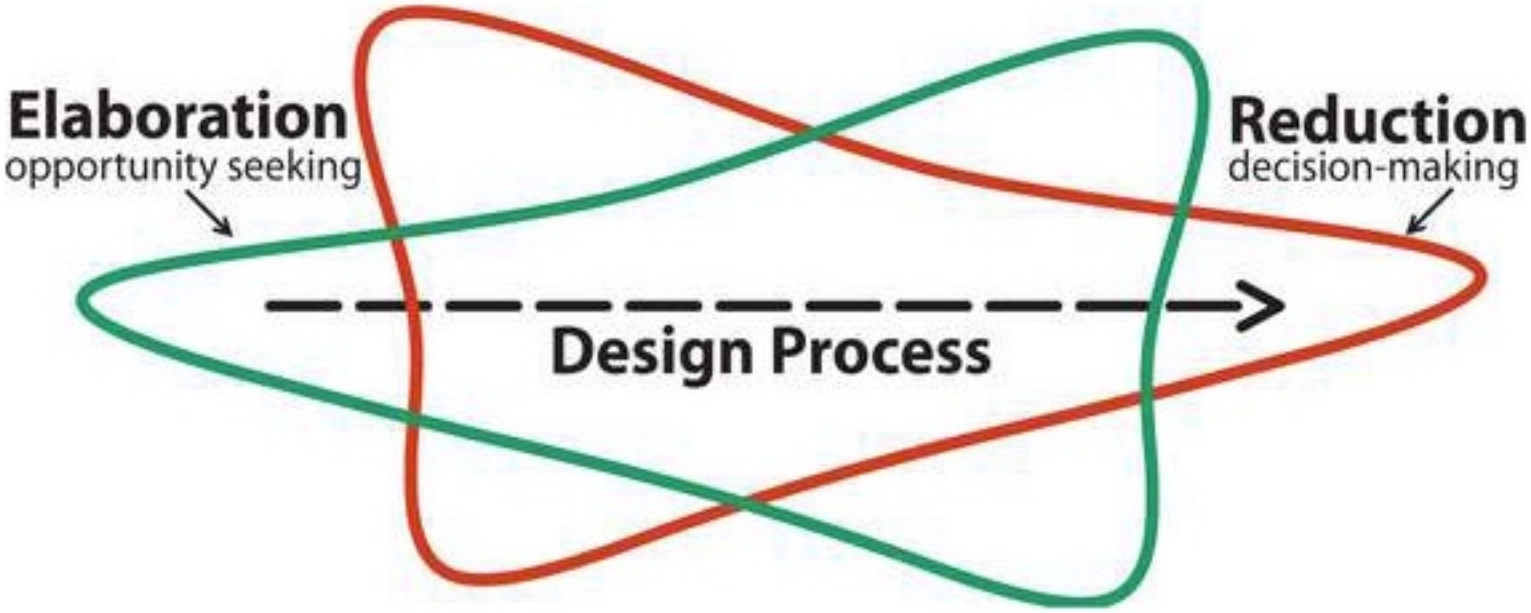
BEATBEARING FINISHED (?) PRODUCT – PETER BENNETT



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MJe0nsLt1H4



Greenberg. The design process as a tree. At any moment in time, explore multiple options.



Laseau's "Design Funnel." From Greenberg. Complementary and simultaneous processes of elaboration and reduction.



Sketching also allows **Iteration**. In addition to the branching metaphor, we can think of a cyclic metaphor, where we can revisit any number of concepts with slight variations or alterations.

Sketching Warmup
(see Greenberg Chapter 3.3)

1. Digital devices
    - Cell phone, laptop, tablet, keyboard, mouse

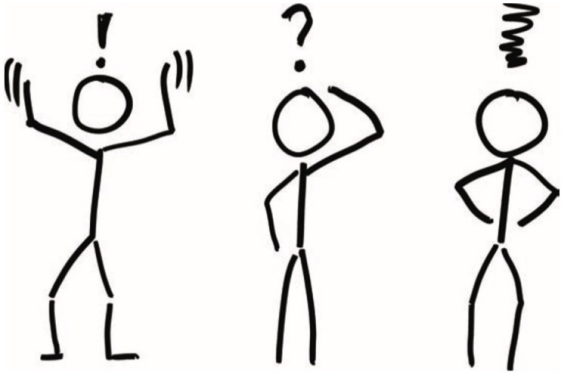
2. Musical instruments
    - Piano, drum, trumpet, violin

3. People
    - Try some variations: stick person, star person, box person, blob person

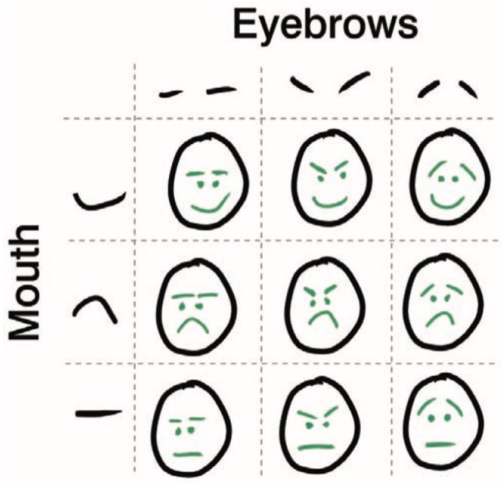
4. Activities
    - Pointing, running, lifting

Going farther: Sketching Vocabulary
(from Greenberg Chapter 3.3)

5 **Bodies and Emotions**
Different postures can also show the state of the person: surprised, puzzled, disgruntled. Here, we also used symbols above the head of the person (in addition to posture) as an additional indicator of a person's state.



6 **Faces and Emotions**
Through simple variations of how you draw people's faces (in particular their mouth and eyebrows) you can let your sketched people express their emotions. The 3x3 grid illustrates 9 different combinations of how to draw people's faces, simpy by the way you remix 6 eyebrow and mouth shapes. The result is expressions such as: happy, relieved, sad, angry, confused, or surprised.



Going farther: Sketching Vocabulary
(from Greenberg Chapter 3.3)

7 **Combining Postures and Faces**
Adding a body posture matching the person's facial expression can amplify how you communicate the person's current emotional state. For example, this sketch shows a person in three different moods: happy and waving the hand, angry and raising the arms, and scratching the head while being confused.



8 **Combining Different Sketch Elements to Illustrate Situations**
You can combine these postures of people and the simple objects to compose simple sketches that illustrate specific situations and actions. For example, the sketches below illustrate a person in different moods and situations: happy while being on the phone, confused while deciphering a map, and sad while searching the floor for a lost item.



Buttons and handles

Verplank theorizes about the distinction between two ways of interacting with a digital system:

Buttons: discrete inputs that have 2 states — on or off

and

Handles: inputs that are continuous, that allow a wide range.

Sketch one specific button and one specific handle that you have personal, direct experience with. Choose ones that are notable, that you especially like or dislike.

Discussion of Buxton article.

What are Buxton's main ideas?

From “interface design” to “experience design”



- We aren’t designing a *thing*, but we are designing an experience that someone will have when interacting with the thing.



Wang, *Artful Design*



Wang, *Artful Design*

Notice How the Experience Unfolds ***Over Time***



Wang, *Artful Design*

Form & function
-unifying
-non-arbitrary relationship

Pleasure, Playfulness

Personality

Inevitability

Aesthetic Experience
- Not primarily from ***looking at it*** but instead from ***using it***

Implications of Experience Design

Experiences are:

messy
open-ended
temporal
individual
situated
contingent
intersecting

Exercise

Think of a technological interaction you have had that has this quality of ”transcendence” that Wang describes; where the experience goes beyond just getting something done, but has a joyful, playful, fun, pleasing or fulfilling quality.

What features are important in giving it that quality?

Can you sketch it?

Interaction Aesthetics from the ***Spectator's Perspective***



Boiler Room

Barista Skills



https://youtu.be/M-LwxHQg-JI

But is there an inherent aesthetic to watching skilled activity?



https://youtu.be/Q5HvaeVeOkw









Style and Structure

What about pressing buttons?



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z_zIvFYQWig

Exercise

Consider a mundane, frequent interaction with an electronic/digital technology that you are familiar with. Something straightforward, for getting a task done. Quickly sketch it.

Share.

We'll select one example. Now sketch a different interaction that accomplishes the same task, but is more playful, joyful, or fun; or offers more possibility for personal style.